

news feed

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hypothesis

WiMAX 802.16

■ What is it?

WiMAX, the IEEE 802.16 Air Interface Standard, has been developed as a wireless metropolitan area network standard. It looks at extending wireless networking to above and beyond the LAN limited Wi-Fi IEEE 802.11 standard.

■ How does it work?

It uses the 10 to 66 GHz frequency spectrum for long distance transmission. An extended standard, the 802.16a utilises the licensed and unlicensed standard in the 2 to 11 GHz spectrum.

■ What does it do?

The WiMAX standard will provide metro-wide wireless networking capability connectivity with its 31-mile range. Its data throughput is about 70 Mbps, which beats the existing 802.11b/g's 11Mbps and 54 Mbps hands down. Moreover, it doesn't require line-of-sight for successful transmission. It will offer a wireless solution for current 'last mile' wired connectivity hassles.

snapshot

29 per cent of American users have **reduced** their overall use of **e-mail** due to abundance of **spam**

Source: Pew Internet & American Life Project

Powell, Sinha *bhai bhai*

Why should a meeting between US Secretary of State Colin Powell and Indian Foreign Minister Yashwant Sinha feature in a technology magazine? Good question. The answer lies in one of the most raging issues of our times—technology outsourcing.

US lawmakers are waging a battle to curb the flow of jobs to offshore locations, where services are offered at unbe-

lievably low rates. Legal moves in the US Senate and Congress threatened to hurt the love



affair between India and the US on the political side.

Powell and Sinha decided that these business issues

will not affect bilateral ties. Powell suggested that India too open up its markets to US investments.

Powell feels outsourcing is a logical offshoot of the technology available today, so if India opens its trade avenues, the US would be able to offset the losses sustained due to current work and job trends.

Still sounds like bullying, if you ask us. Only this time, it is couched in diplomatese.

Meet the new polluting champ: The PC

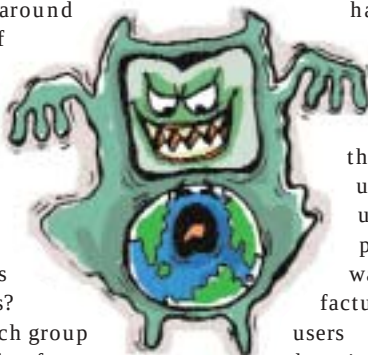
Spoilsports! We admit that the United Nations is doing a great job of preserving world peace, telling the world in advance about the SARS and Avian Flu epidemics and also bringing around one-tenth of Africa out of the clutches of poverty. But really, did they have to tell us that our dear PCs are now the world's worst pollutants?

A UN research group has concluded after years of, well, research, that computers create more pollution than cars as they contain higher amount of toxic chemicals. They say that a PC weighing 24 Kg uses up energy equivalent to 240 Kg of fossil fuels, 22 Kg of chemicals and 1.5 tons of water.

Even after the machine has become useless, the group says, the environmental damage continues. As the discarded PC ends up in a landfill, it

becomes even more hazardous to human health. The only solution to this is to upgrade or reuse the computer hardware by manufacturers and users instead of throwing it away.

PCs contain chemicals such as brominated flame retardants and heavy metals like lead and cadmium. In theory, local water supplies are at greater risk when these chemicals leach into the ground where they are dumped.



Farzana Cooper

Is it a lens? Is it an eye?

Philips wants to get back into the innovation mode. Big time.

At the recently held CeBit technology fair at Hanover in Germany, the Netherlands-headquartered consumer electronics giant debuted a tiny lens that works by manipulating fluids in a tiny tube.

When a small electric current is passed through the two fluids, one of them attaches to its edge, while the other fills up the remaining space. The spot where they touch, functions as a lens.

The 3-mm lens will be used in low cost digital cameras used inside phones.

The lens, whose technology is patented by Philips, can be shaped to be hollow or curved, by changing the current passed. As a result, the lens can focus on objects far away or as close as five centimetres.

Ingenuous, we would say.



■ Macromedia updates Dreamweaver MX 2004, runs 50 per cent faster on a PC ■ Sony to launch personalised radio service for phones